

NAMAN DHIR, *25*
Mumbai Indians

MATCHES: 16 RUNS: 252
AVG: 31.5 STRIKE RATE: 182.6

Mumbai Indians needed an 'impact player' in IPL 2025 and they found it in Naman Dhir. The Punjab youngster was their go-to batter in the death overs. Dhir didn't have a single 50, but he had more runs in the death overs—190—than any other batsman and he made them at a stunning strike rate of 195.9. This year, Naman also had four knocks, with a strike rate of over 200 and five more innings with a strike rate of between 150 and 200. Nothing exemplified Dhir's role as a finisher better than the Qualifier 2 semifinal clash against Punjab Kings. Mumbai Indians were in danger of setting a sub-par total before Dhir arrived and played a blinder, hitting 37 runs off 18 balls—including seven boundaries—to help the five-time champions cross the 200-runs mark. In the end, it wasn't enough and MI lost, but the right-hander's knock had at least given Hardik Pandya's team something to fight for.

—SV





tions" for the big stage. If true, it did the job, for Arya was giving the Kings a blistering start in most games. With a strike rate just shy of 180, the top highlight among his knocks was a hundred off 39 balls against Chennai Super Kings, the joint second-fastest century in the history of the IPL. PBKS may have fallen at the final hurdle, but Arya did end up with one more record—his 475 runs was the most by an uncapped India batter in his debut IPL season.

—SV